

HCI Assignment 1

Find out one example of good user interface design and one example of bad user interface design.

For each example:

- describe the objective of the whole interface
- describe the good or bad aspects
- explain why it is good or bad
- for bad cases, tell why, do you think, it was designed that way and suggest corrections or improvements
- **whenever possible, illustrate with images.**

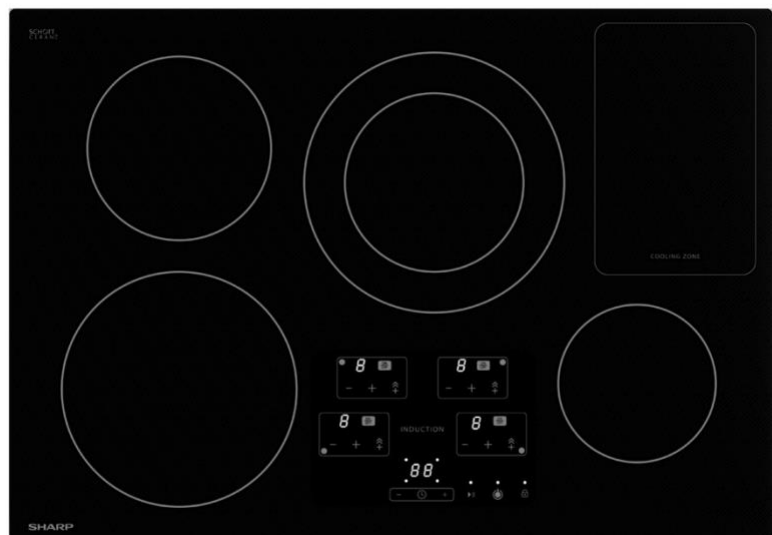
Good User Interface Design Example

An induction cooktop (by SHARP)

The objective of the interface is to communicate clearly where pots should be placed to cook by delimiting each zone with a white edge. The controls for each burner are also well delimited and deliver immediate information through an LCD display.

The good aspects of the interface are:

- **Simplicity:** reduced visual clutter allows to know immediately where to position pots and how to operate the single burners.
- **Clear marking of commands:** each burner is operated by a separate control zone with clearly marked controls, limited to four in number (on/off button, less power, more power, boosted power).
- **Immediate communication of power:** the LCD along with the spy beside it immediately communicate if the relative burner is switched on, at which power operates and if the surface is still hot. The user receives feedback from every operation visually and with a confirmation sound.
- **Cooling zone:** the cooktop also offers a cooling zone where to put hot pans, instead of having to rely on a trivet or risking ruining the kitchen surfaces.
- **Safety:** the burners turn on only when a pot is detected and automatically turns off when it's not detected anymore; while a classic gas burner can be turned on whenever,



exposing an open flame. This cooktop also offers a lock function, which can prevent children from operating it accidentally.

- Convenience of use features: a timer is also present, allowing automatic switching off, especially convenient for long cooking preparations. The cooktop consists entirely of a glass plane, making cleaning extremely easy.

The bad aspects are:

- The control displays could more clearly mark which burner they control instead of relying only on relative positioning and an indication dot.
- All information is communicated visually, the design could be made more accessible by adding tactile raised markings, especially for the controls.
- The cooling zone appears to be very close to the top-right burner, which would be impractical when both are used

Bad User Interface Design

Example

TCL TV remote

The objective of this remote is to control a smart TV. It was clearly designed with simplicity in mind.

Its strong aspects are:

- Simplicity: the buttons are few and clearly marked, allowing a less cluttered look.
- Modern integration: differently from a traditional remote, this one provides dedicated buttons for common streaming services, paired with voice control through Google's voice assistant.
- Big navigation wheel: the navigation wheel occupies most of the space and is clearly marked, allowing easy operation in menus.

Its weak aspects are:

- Too few buttons: while designed with modern streaming services in mind, it forgets how traditional satellite TV channels are managed. The lack of traditional numbered buttons forces the user to press a specific button to open an on-screen menu to input the number of the channel desired. Alternatively, the user can scroll through the channels one-by-one, making channel changes annoying.



- Too large buttons: the bottom buttons are too large and prone to accidental press, which disrupts the user experience by opening a streaming service app to which the user, most of the time, doesn't have a subscription to. The opening is usually slow and exiting requires different button presses.
- Too simple design: while designed to be minimalistic and sleek, most buttons do not communicate clearly to the user what their respective menu is, forcing the user to learn what each button does with trial and error instead of being intuitive.